



The Orite VC-5000Z

good, making it convenient to operate despite the weight.

The Sony model, with its one-side-rounded design, stands out. But the tiny icons on the screen are a real strain for the eyes. The button placement is good. The flash is intelligently tilted towards the lens to get sufficient light on the subject.

How Did They Perform?

We tested the credentials of the cameras at taking shots of scenery. We shot a mountain for the test. While taking the photographs, we selected the Landscape mode. For cameras that did not come with Landscape, we used the Auto mode. In Landscape photography, the Nikon Coolpix 4100 fared better than the rest. It showed good colour reproduction and saturation.

The Sony P73 returned a slightly darker image, whereas the Kodak CX7330 gave an image that was a little brighter. The Casio Exilim was a letdown. The image was dark, while the colour reproduction suffered heavily.

The Nikon Coolpix 4100 is the ideal digital camera for shooting in hill stations or lush valleys.

In the Sports mode, we didn't come across too much variation in image quality and finer details. The Canon A75 and the Nikon Coolpix 4100 were ahead of the rest. We managed to capture a moving trailer as a still. The text on the trailer's container was clearly visible without any blur.

The Casio, too, managed to capture a moving vehicle, but there was some blurring on the photo. In some of the cameras, such as the Kodak CX7430, the shutter speed was not fast enough. So, we managed to capture the back half of a fast-moving vehicle, even though we had released the shutter button when the vehicle entered the frame. It effectively means that with the CX7430, you have to anticipate and then shoot.

The D'zign returned an image peppered with red, green and blue dots. However, it managed to

The Sony P100 has the superior Carl Zeiss lens and powers up instantly. Its compact shape and unique design allows for one hand photography without problem

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capture the moving car we were trying to shoot.

The Portrait test was done indoors in a sufficiently lit place. The room was lit up with tube-lights, and there were no incandescent bulbs. Despite this, some of the images came across as shot with lots of studio lights on.

The Nikon Coolpix 4100, impressed again, as skin tone was captured perfectly, and so were the colours. The flash of the 4100 created excess brightness in the centre of a frame. To negate bright spots on the photo, we maintained a distance of three to five feet from the subject and made use of the zoom. The Samsung Digimax 301, too, gave us an impressive portrait image. However, there were some minor niggles in reproducing the skin tone. Due to the powerful flash, the 301 returned an image



A red cast is prominent in this image captured with Samsung's Diigimax 370



Jargon Buster

Shutter Speed Indicates how long the shutter of the camera stays open to expose the sensor. Higher shutter speeds are required to take clearer still pictures of fast moving objects, such as speeding cars or the wings of a bee, which would otherwise show as a blur.

For artistic photography, a blur is sometimes required, for example a flowing river or the trail left by the light of a firefly. This is obtained by slowing the shutter speed.

Aperture It is the size of the opening in the lens that decides the amount of light captured by the film or sensor.

A larger aperture (represented by a lower f-value, for eg f/2) offers a shallow depth of field. Focus is locked to the main subject, causing anything ahead of or behind it to appear out of focus.

A smaller aperture (i.e. higher f-value, for eg f/16) offers greater depth of field. This lets you focus on objects which form the ambience to your subject.

White Balance To a digital camera, a white object might take on other hues depending upon lighting conditions. This is not acceptable. Depending on the light source, you can adjust the white balance of a camera to ensure correct reproduction of colours in the frame.

Common settings are daylight, cloudy, fluorescent (to be used for tube lighting), and incandescent (to be used in bulb lighting).

Red-Eye Reduction A red-eye is caused when flash-light reflects back to the camera, picking up the red colour from the blood vessels in the retina of the eyes. In Red-Eye Reduction mode, the flash goes off multiple times, causing the pupils of the eye to contract. The photo is taken with the last flash, whose light doesn't reflect back the red of the eyes.

Burst Mode Also known as Continuous Mode, this is the camera's ability to take several images in quick succession. How fast, how many, and at what quality, depends on the inbuilt buffer memory of the camera. Most consumer digital cameras manage one to three shots per second, while professional ones score up to seven. Usually, the quality increases with the decrease in the number of shots, and vice-versa.

Electronic View Finder (EVF) An EVF is a small LCD in place of the optical view finder that you hold close to your eye. The EVF gets its image through the lens. It is accurate and does not suffer from parallax errors. Since it is enclosed in a casing, it is usable even in bright light when an LCD can be unreadable.

that was really bright. The Canon A75 impressed with its great details, but the overall image had a mild red cast all over. The photo eventually needed quite a lot of colour correction.

The Orite VC-5000Z returned an image similar to that of the Canon A75. In fact, the red cast was even more pronounced in Orite's image.

We also set up a test image comprising a red motherboard. It had lots of tiny and shining components on it. Its CPU socket, the PCI slot and the memory slots were used to evaluate the details. We also used boxes of software (such as Windows XP Professional) to test the focus of the cameras. The colourful nature of such boxes along with the associated text made them an ideal for the test. Once again, the Nikon topped the list. Its images showed wonderful colour reproduction. When it came to details, it fared much better than the rest of the